



Plants for woodland gardens

Cool, shady forests are home to a range of elegant shrubs, climbers, bulbs, and perennials—visit native woodlands for inspiration.

Use seasonal variations to the best effect in your woodland garden. Spring is the highlight of the year, when bulbs and flowers come into bloom, making the most of the light before the tree canopies darken the woodland floor. As summer approaches, use foliage plants such as ferns to provide interest and grow foxglove and other flowers in the partial shade at the edge of the tree line. For a fall display, choose maples, whose red and orange foliage burns brightly, and berried plants for added color. Winter stems make an impact when foliage has fallen, creating a graphic picture as temperatures tumble.



SHRUB LARGE

Aesculus parviflora

BOTTLEBRUSH BUCKEY This suckering deciduous shrub has palm-shaped bronze leaves, which age to dark green and turn yellow in fall, and spikes of fluffy white flowers from mid- to late summer. Plant it in gaps between trees.

↑10ft (3m) ↔15ft (5m)

☀️ ⚠️ Z4–8 (N)



BULB MEDIUM

Allium moly

GOLDEN GARLIC This is a clump-forming perennial bulb with narrow, lance-shaped gray-green leaves. In summer, domed heads of star-shaped golden-yellow blooms appear. It is an ideal plant for naturalizing in deciduous woodland.

↑14in (35cm)

☀️ ⚠️ Z3–9



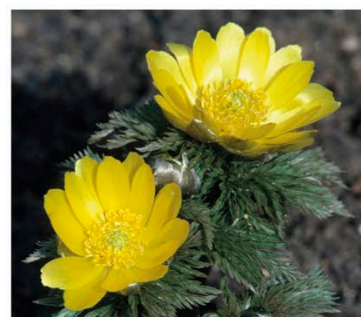
PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Actaea pachypoda

WHITE BANEBERRY This clump-forming perennial has divided bright green leaves. Spikes of fluffy white midsummer flowers are followed by oval, black-tipped white berries on stiff bright red stalks. Plant it in moist soil just beyond tree canopies.

↑3ft (1m) ↔20in (50cm)

☀️ ⚠️ Z3–8 (N)



PERENNIAL SMALL

Adonis amurensis

AMUR ADONIS A clump-forming perennial with ferny midgreen leaves. In early spring, just as the foliage unfolds, golden-yellow, cup-shaped single blooms with many small petals appear. Grow it in part or full shade in soil that does not dry out.

↑↔12in (30cm)

☀️ pH Z4–7



BULB MEDIUM

Anemone blanda 'Violet Star'

GRECIAN WINDFLOWER A tuber-forming, spreading perennial bulb with dark green divided leaves and daisy-like, amethyst-violet flowers with white centers in early spring. Plant the tubers in fall. Keep the plant well watered.

↑6in (15cm)

☀️ ⚠️ Z5–8



BULB SMALL

Anemone blanda 'White Splendour'

GRECIAN WINDFLOWER This tuber-forming perennial bulb forms carpets of divided leaves. Daisy-like white flowers appear in early spring. Plant the tubers in groups in fall.

↑4in (10cm)

☀️ ⚠️ Z5–8



PERENNIAL SMALL

Anemone nemorosa

WOOD ANEMONE This vigorous carpeting perennial has deeply cut midgreen leaves and, from spring to early summer, daisy-like flowers with a central tuft of yellow stamens. Suitable for naturalizing, it is available in many colors and flower forms.

↑6in (15cm) ↔12in (30cm)

☀️ ⚠️ Z4–8



PERENNIAL SMALL

Anemone sylvestris

SNOWDROP WINDFLOWER This carpeting perennial has divided midgreen leaves and, from spring to early summer, white bowl-shaped flowers with yellow centers. With its spreading roots, it may become aggressive; suitable for wild gardens.

↑↔12in (30cm)

☀️ ⚠️ Z3–8